31. This forms the subtitle of the book written by Basham (1951).

32. Ibid.: 3–9.

33. Ibid.: 135.

34. Ibid.

35. *Vinaya* ii.284, cited in Basham (1951): 136. Also see ‘Maha Parinibbana Suttanta’, *Digha Nikaya* ii.162, in Rhys Davids (1910): vol. II, 183–4. Here too, the same story, about the encounter between Maha-Kassapa with monks and an Ajivika along the high road to Pava, is mentioned.

36. Basham (1951): 140–1.

37. *Vamsatthappakasini* is cited on this point by Guruge (1993): 26

38. Law (1954): 8–9.

39. For the texts of the epigraphs, Hultzsch (1925): 181–2.

40. For a description of the Barabar caves, Gupta (1980): 189–221.

41. Strong (1989: 27), draws our attention to the presence of some Ashoka stories being represented on the second–first centuries BCE bas-reliefs of the great stupa at Sanchi.

42. Strong (1989): 174.

43. Chapter VI of the *Mahavamsa*. See Geiger (1912): 51. The text tells us that on seeing the tiger she ‘bethought of the prophesy of the soothsayers which she had heard, and without fear she caressed him stroking his limbs.’ Twins, a son and a daughter, were born of this union. All the following references to Geiger (1912) refer to his translation of the *Mahavamsa*.

44. Geiger (1912): 65.

45. Kane (1994): vol. V, pt I, 526.

46. VII.64. See Karambelkar (1959): 154.

47. For a summary, Hilton (1996). Also see Kargupta (2002), especially chapter 5.

48. The ones mentioned are: Jyestha or Vicrt (i.e. Mula nakshatra) or a day called tiger-like (on an evil or terrible nakshatra). Kane (1994): vol. V, pt I, 524.

49. Ibid.: 531.

50. Ibid.: 532.

51. Rowley (1956): 7–8.

52. Tottoli (2002): 22.

53. See Moore (1921): 110.